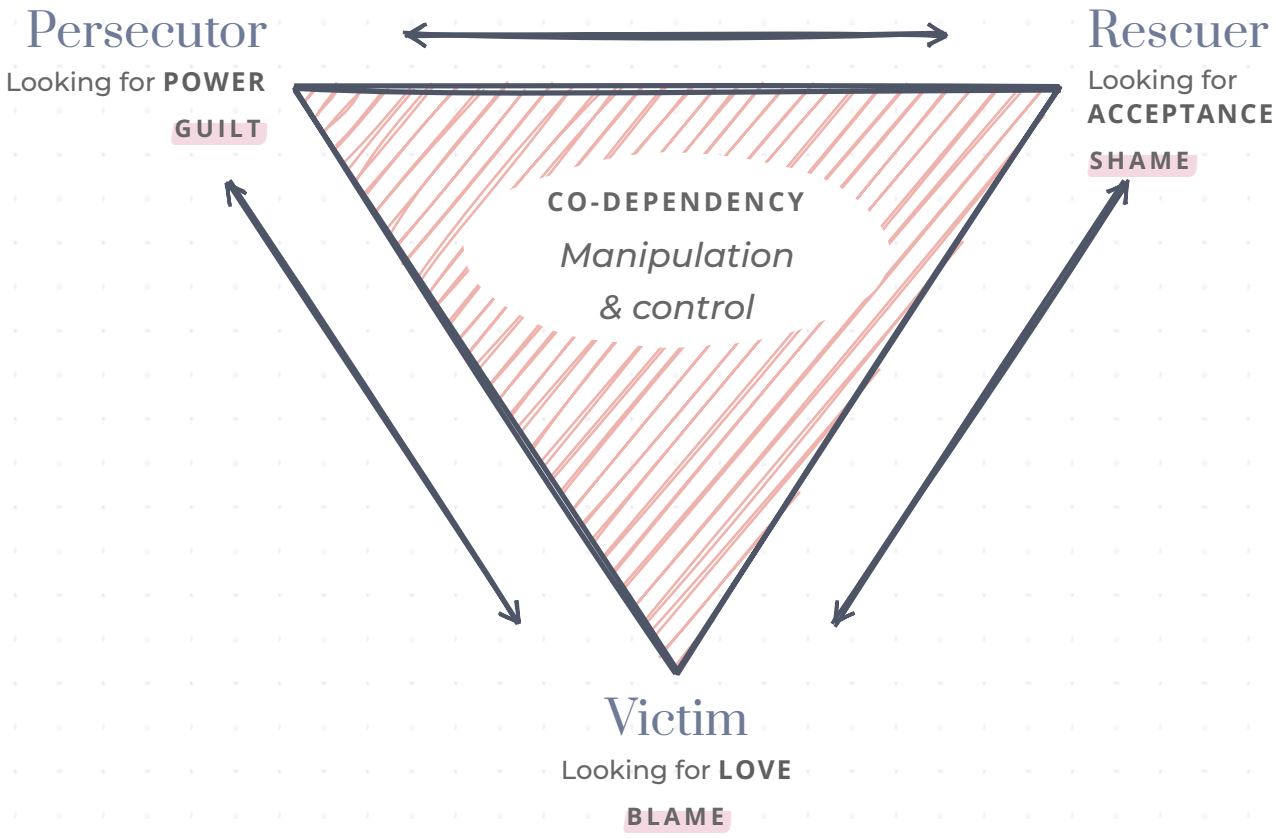
UNDERSTANDING RELATIONSHIP PATTERNS

Karpman's Drama Triangle

Three roles we can slip into when relationships get stuck. Each role is *looking for* something, and each one keeps the drama going.



Persecutor

"I'm right." "I can make you do it."

- Points the finger and finds fault
- Has angry outbursts
- Lack of compassion
- Claims perfection
- Judges others
- Discounts others' feelings, value and dignity
- Comes from the Controlling Parent (dominates)

Rescuer

"I'm good." "I can do it for you."

- Controlling tendencies
- Gives unwanted advice
- Over-extends (does more than 50%)
- Takes on everyone's problems, being the hero
- Comes from the Nurturing Parent (marshmallowing)

Victim

ANGRY VICTIM OR PATHETIC VICTIM

"I'm blameless." "Please do it for me."

- Most vulnerable, often helpless
- Accepts the role of being treated badly
- Depressed, fearful, low self-esteem
- Looks for answers from others and discounts self
- Believes they can't think and feel at the same time
- Seeks a Persecutor to confirm the discount, and a Rescuer to confirm the belief of not coping
- Does less than 50% of the work
- Comes from the Adapted Child (feels helpless)

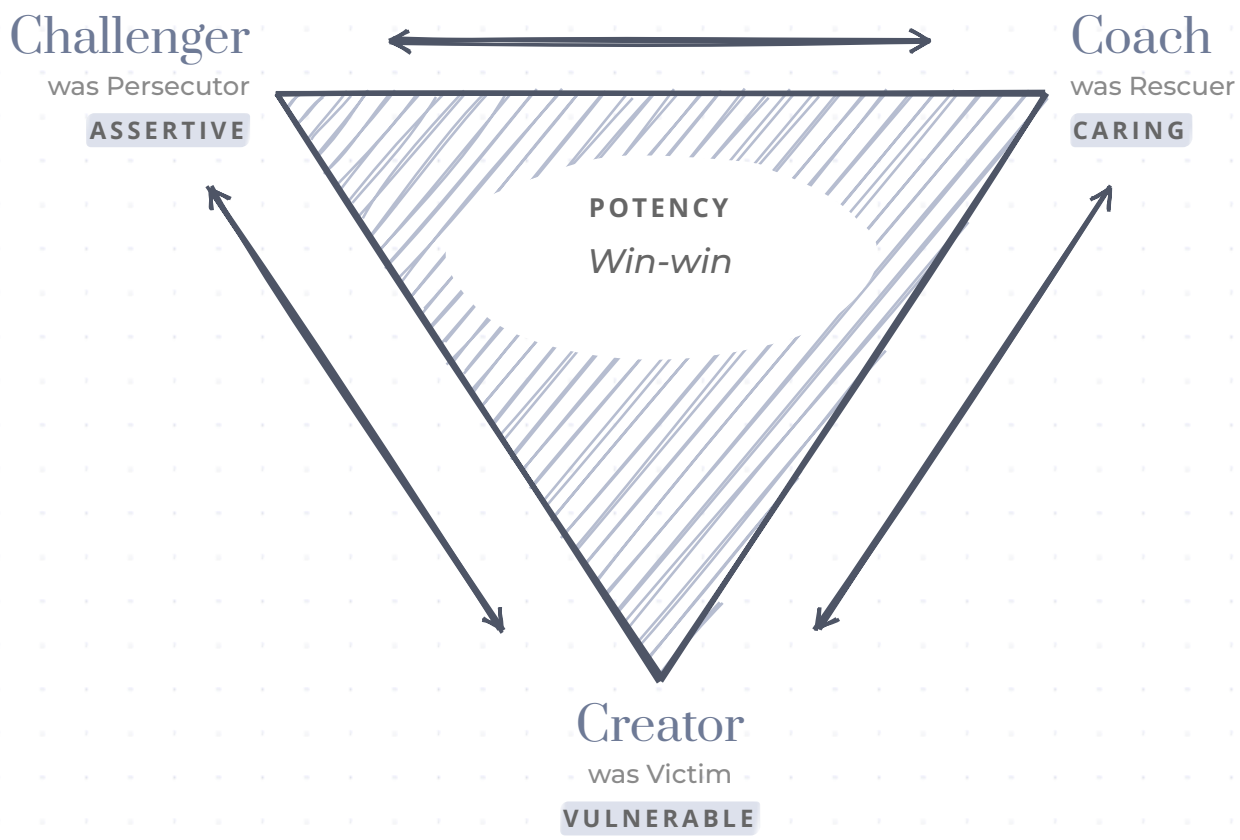
Reference
Karpman, S. B. (1968). Fairy tales and script drama analysis. *Transactional Analysis Bulletin*, 7(26), 39–43.

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THE HEALTHY ALTERNATIVE

The Winner's Triangle

The same three positions, turned into something healthy. Here everyone can win.



Challenger

BE ASSERTIVE & POWERFUL

- It's OK to say what you want and need
- It's OK to negotiate
- It's OK for you to be assertive and powerful
- The same applies to everyone else
- Everyone can walk powerfully and assertively in their own light, without others criticising and judging them

Coach

BE CARING & RESPONSIVE

- Genuinely care for others
- Don't let neediness drive you
- Be responsive to their needs (help only when asked)
- Know that you can affirm yourself
- Stick to your boundaries
- Don't be an overfunctioner

Creator

BE VULNERABLE & VOICE YOUR FEELINGS

- Acknowledge your vulnerability by making your needs known
- Take accountability and responsibility, knowing you can solve your problems with or without the help of others
- Feel free to say no to the rescuers in your life
- Create your own reality

Reference
Choy, A. (1990). The Winner's Triangle. *Transactional Analysis Journal*, 20(1).

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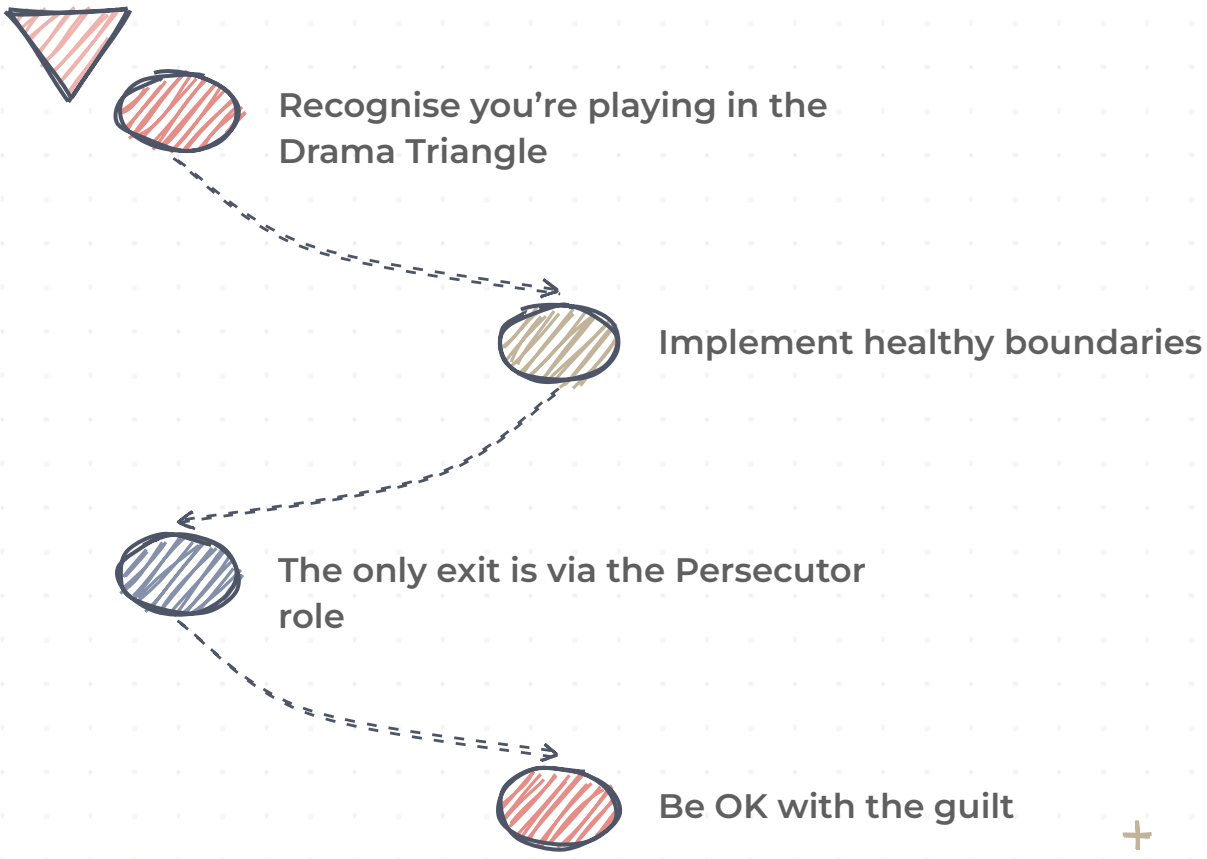
STEPPING OUT OF THE TRIANGLE

Staying away from drama

EACH ROLE HAS A HEALTHY TWIN

Persecutor	→	Challenger ASSERTIVE & POWERFUL
Rescuer	→	Coach CARING & RESPONSIVE
Victim	→	Creator VULNERABLE & VOICES FEELINGS

FOUR STEPS OUT





No more living on autopilot and perpetuating the drama in your life. Instead, be a winner by intentionally choosing the Winner's Triangle.

References

Karpman, S. B. (1968). Fairy tales and script drama analysis. *Transactional Analysis Bulletin*, 7(26), 39–43.

Choy, A. (1990). The Winner's Triangle. *Transactional Analysis Journal*, 20(1).

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